

Plain Language Statement

School of Computing and Information Systems

Technology Innovation Project



Student Researchers:

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Introduction

Thank you for your interest in participating in this research project. The following few pages will provide you with further information about the project, so that you can decide if you would like to take part in this research.

Please take the time to read this information carefully. You may ask questions about anything you don't understand or want to know more about.

Your participation is voluntary. If you don't wish to take part, you don't have to. If you begin participating, you can also stop at any time.

What is this research about?

In this student project, groups of postgraduate students will investigate *how individuals seek and provide help within their local communities, and explore the design of a digital platform that connects people with nearby support services*. The aim of the project is to understand *user needs, challenges, and expectations when accessing or offering local help, and to evaluate how technology can improve accessibility, trust, and efficiency in community support*.

What will I be asked to do?

Should you agree to participate, you will be asked to:

- Take part in a short interview or complete an online survey about your experiences with seeking or providing help in your local community (approximately 10–20 minutes).
- Answer questions about your preferences, challenges, and expectations when using digital platforms.
- (Optional) Provide feedback on a simple prototype or concept design of a proposed platform.

What are the possible benefits?

There are no direct personal benefits from participating in this study. However, your input will contribute to the development of an innovative solution aimed at improving access to local support services and strengthening community connections. Your feedback may help inform better-designed digital platforms in the future.

What are the possible risks?

This study involves minimal risk. Some participants may feel slight discomfort when reflecting on personal experiences; however, you are free to skip any questions you do not wish to answer.

All information provided will be kept confidential and used only for research purposes.

Do I have to take part?

No. Participation is completely voluntary. You are able to withdraw at any time.

Will I hear about the results of this project?

If you wish to read the report from the project, please contact the student researchers directly.

What will happen to information about me?

Student researchers will store your data on a password-protected computer system. It will be deleted after the research project ends when the students complete their studies. You will be referred to by a pseudonym in reporting the research.

Where can I get further information?

If you would like more information about the project, please contact the student researchers [insert project students' contact details].; or the subject coordinator, Professor Taehun Rhee <taehyun.rhee@unimelb.edu.au>.